PROGRAM MANAGEMENT CASE STUDY

NEW MARKET LAUNCH & OPERATIONAL READINESS

A simulated new-city launch of an existing consumer service, planned across five two-week sprints.

PROJECT 03 • PORTFOLIO SAMPLE

EXECUTIVE OVERVIEW

Build launch confidence through clear ownership, dependency control and evidence-based decisions.

10 WEEKS
Illustrative delivery horizon

7
Cross-functional workstreams

5
Execution sprints

≥90%
Target readiness score

Prepared as an illustrative portfolio artifact; all targets and records require validation.

Executive Brief

THE PROGRAM CHALLENGE

Launch a proven consumer service in a new city while protecting customer experience, compliance and operational stability.

PROGRAM MANAGER FOCUS

- Integrate seven workstreams into one launch plan and decision cadence.
- Surface critical dependencies, capacity gaps and unresolved risks early.
- Use readiness evidence and explicit Go/No-Go criteria to govern launch.

DECISION PRINCIPLE

A high readiness score doesn’t authorize launch: mandatory controls and critical approvals must be satisfied.

SCOPE BOUNDARY

The case assumes an existing consumer service and established teams. It demonstrates transferable program-management practices without requiring specialist domain expertise.

Outcomes and Success Measures

Illustrative target measures — not actual results or achieved performance.

95%+

Critical launch activities complete

100%

Critical launch dependencies resolved

95%+

Mandatory training completion

100%

Critical vendors ready

100%

Critical compliance approvals

0

Unmitigated critical risks at Go/No-Go

GATE: Go/No-Go decision documented before launch; any exception requires explicit authorized approval.

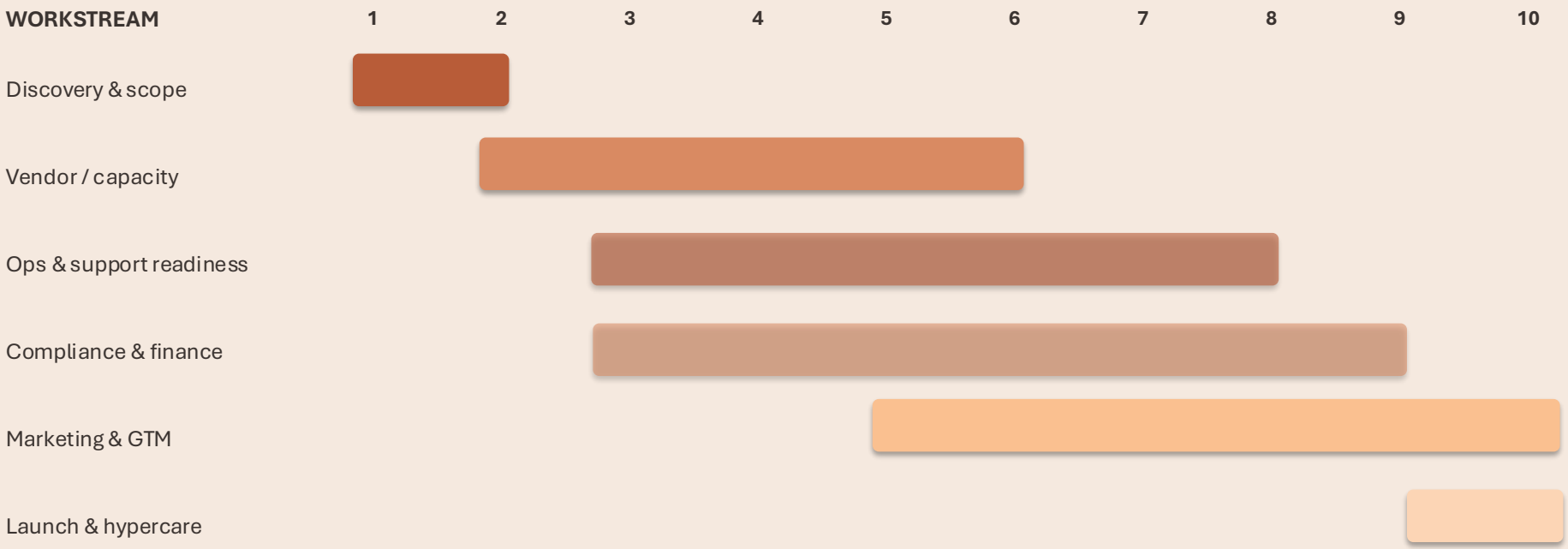
Operating Model: Seven Workstreams



Cadence: weekly governance • risk/dependency review • readiness checkpoint

Integrated plan and dependency control

Illustrative five-sprint plan (10 working weeks); calendar dates follow the configured Azure DevOps iterations.



WEEK 1 → 10

Key Dependencies: vendor capacity → operations sign-off • compliance approvals → campaign release • readiness evidence → Go/No-Go

Top risks, assumptions and dependencies

ITEM	EXPOSURE	RESPONSE / EVIDENCE
Vendor capacity	Launch demand may exceed confirmed partner capacity.	Obtain written capacity/SLA confirmation; document gaps and contingency.
Cross-functional hand-offs	Late or unclear inputs may delay critical path.	Name accountable owners, due dates and acceptance criteria; review weekly.
Compliance approvals	Required approvals may arrive after campaign or launch	Maintain approval checklist and escalation path; no release without required approval.
Staffing assumptions	Launch roles and demand forecasts may be incomplete.	Validate forecast, operating hours, roles and staffing gaps with Operations.

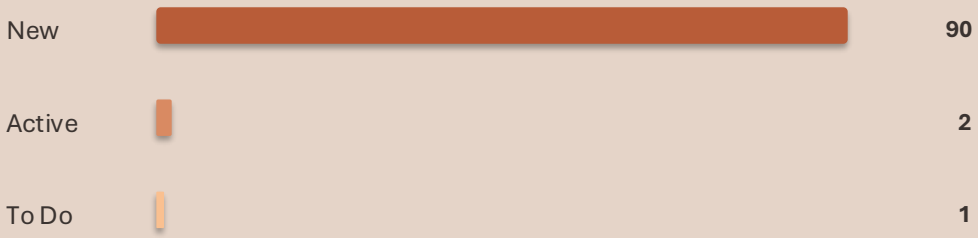
Governance rule: Every critical risk must have an accountable owner, response plan, trigger and escalation path.

Executive reporting and launch decision

PROGRAM DASHBOARD | SAMPLE VIEW

92	Open work items
1	Open risk / issue
5	Sprints
7	Workstreams

Work-item status (illustrative current setup)



GO / NO-GO READINESS CRITERIA

- Critical compliance approvals evidenced.
- Critical vendor capacity and SLAs confirmed.
- Staffing, support coverage and training ready.
- Critical dependencies resolved or formally accepted.
- No unmitigated critical risks; exceptions authorised.
- Decision, rationale, owners and actions recorded.

Readiness score supports the decision; it does not replace mandatory controls.

Launch, hypercare and reusable playbook

PRE-LAUNCH	GO / NO-GO	HYPERCARE	CLOSE & REUSE
Confirm owners, evidence, capacity, approvals and decision rights.	Review scorecard, critical dependencies, open risks and exceptions.	Monitor incidents, customer support demand, vendor SLAs and operational stability.	Capture lessons learned; update templates, readiness criteria and launch playbook.

Reusable outputs: launch checklist • dependency map • RAID register • readiness scorecard • decision log • hypercare dashboard

Portfolio note: replace sample measures with validated evidence and link to the editable artifacts.